Andy Glover added an offhand question in one of his emails: "Quick question—what are your thoughts on BDD?" "Bee what?" I thought to myself, before running off to read Dan North's seminal article on the topic.[1] And it immediately clicked. Dan had crystalized what I thought the next steps in testing practices should be.

I soon became involved in the BDD community, contributing to Andy's BDD tool for Groovy, easyb,[2] and experimenting with other BDD tools and approaches, and BDD soon became an invaluable part of my tool kit when helping teams out with their agile adoption.

Fast-forward four years: on a sunny summer day in January 2011, I met Andrew Walker in a cafe opposite Hyde Park in Sydney to discuss helping to get his teams started with TDD, BDD, and test automation. Andrew became a good friend, and we had many fascinating discussions, particularly around the ideas of Agile requirements management, executable specifications, and living documentation.

The Thucydides[3] project was born of these conversations and from an idea—would it be possible to produce meaningful living documentation by observing the execution of automated acceptance tests as they run?

Andrew was also the one to point out that I should write a book on the topic. In early 2013, I finally got in touch with the folks at Manning with the idea of a book on BDD. They were interested, and so a new book project was launched!

This book is a labor of love about a topic I hold close to my heart. I regularly see confusion and misunderstanding in the community about what BDD is (and isn't). One of the goals of this book is to give the broader software development community a better understanding of what BDD is, where it can be used, and how it can help. My hope is that you will find as many benefits in practicing BDD as I have.

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[1] http://dannorth.net/introducing-bdd/, first published in March 2006

[2] http://easyb.org/

[3] http://thucydides.info